LDN → DXB PROPERTY DESK

Your Dubai Address, Secured from London.

A practical guide to buying Dubai property
for UK residents and NRIs — remotely, and without the guesswork.

Free guide for prospective buyers · No cost, no obligation

ldn-dxb-property-desk · independent referral introducer, UK

Before you read further

Who this guide is for

This guide is written for UK residents and NRIs (non-resident Indians based in the UK) who are curious about Dubai property but haven't taken a serious look yet — landlords frustrated with UK buy-to-let returns, families exploring a Golden Visa, and investors who simply want a second, tax-efficient asset outside the UK.

It's deliberately short and plain. No sales pitch, no inflated numbers — just the six things almost everyone asks about first, the real process end to end, and the honest caveats that go with any property investment.

0%	5–8%	100%	0
Property & rental income tax*	Typical gross rental yield*	Foreign freehold ownership	Flights required to purchase

Indicative figures based on general market conditions. Yields and tax treatment vary by property, area and buyer circumstances — not a guarantee. Always take independent advice.

Section 1

The six things every buyer asks about first

01 · Tax

No personal property tax

Dubai levies no annual property tax, capital gains tax, or tax on rental income at the personal level. UK (and, for NRIs, Indian) tax rules on your worldwide income may still apply to you personally — this is a UAE-side benefit, not a substitute for advice on your own tax position.

02 · Visa

A path to UAE residency

Property investment above the qualifying threshold (from roughly AED 2 million) can support a long-term UAE Golden Visa, giving you and eligible family members renewable residency — useful for buyers who want a Gulf base, not just a rental asset.

03 · Yield

Rental yields UK buyers notice

Gross yields in established Dubai communities have historically run well above typical UK buy-to-let returns. Figures vary by building, area and market cycle — treat any number you're given as indicative, not promised.

04 · Ownership

Full freehold, as a foreigner

In designated freehold areas, foreign buyers — resident or not — can own property outright, not on leasehold, with title registered in their own name via the Dubai Land Department.

05 · Safety

Regulated transactions

Off-plan payments in Dubai are legally required to sit in RERA-supervised escrow accounts, released to the developer against construction milestones — a structural protection buyers specifically ask about.

06 · Lifestyle

Connectivity & livability

Direct flights from most UK cities, a large resident South Asian and British community, and infrastructure built around global residents — relevant if this is a future home, not only an investment.

Section 2

UK vs. Dubai, side by side

For UK-based landlords especially, the comparison usually comes down to net return after tax, and how much friction is involved in owning the asset.

	UK Buy-to-Let	Dubai
Property tax	Applies (varies by council)	**0%**
Capital gains tax on sale	Up to 28%	**0%**
Typical net rental yield	2–4%	**5–8%***
Ownership for foreigners	N/A (UK residents)	**100% freehold, designated zones**
Currency exposure	GBP-native	**AED, pegged to USD**

**Yields are indicative and vary by building, area, and market cycle — not a guarantee of performance.*

A worked example

On a £300,000 property: a UK buy-to-let at 2–4% net yield returns roughly £6,000–£12,000 a year after typical costs. The same capital in a Dubai property at 5–8% gross yield could return £15,000–£24,000 a year before local running costs, and with no capital gains tax on sale. This is illustrative only — actual returns depend heavily on the specific property, service charges, and market conditions at the time.

Section 3

If you're an NRI based in the UK

A large share of Dubai's international buyers are Indian nationals and NRIs, and the appeal is slightly different from the general UK-buyer case:

- **Currency hedge** — AED is pegged to USD, offering more stability than holding property priced in Indian Rupees.
- **Simpler cross-border logistics** — a large, established Indian community already lives in Dubai, and direct flights connect most Indian and UK cities to Dubai.
- **No NRI-specific restrictions** — unlike some property markets, Dubai freehold zones don't impose additional foreign-ownership restrictions on NRIs specifically.
- **Yield comparison to India** — typical net yields in major Indian metros run around 2–3%, versus 5–8% gross in established Dubai communities — though direct comparisons should account for different cost structures and currency risk.

Your UK tax residency, and separately your Indian tax position (if applicable), will determine what you owe at home on rental income or gains — this is genuinely worth a conversation with a qualified UK/India tax adviser before you commit to anything.

Section 4

How the process actually works

Buying from the UK sounds more complicated than it is. Here's the real sequence, remotely, start to finish:

01 · TODAY

Share your requirement

A short form: budget, purpose (rental income, Golden Visa, relocation), preferred area, and timeline. Two minutes, no documents needed yet.

02 · WITHIN 24–48H

You're matched to one broker

Your details go to a single vetted, RERA-regulated Dubai broker suited to your budget and goal — not a mass distribution list.

03 · YOUR PACE

Shortlist & virtual tour

Your broker sends a curated shortlist and arranges video or virtual walkthroughs. No pressure, no obligation to proceed.

04 · ON YOUR TERMS

Reserve & complete

Your broker handles reservation, contracts, escrow and handover — remotely, or on your next visit to Dubai.

Section 5

Frequently asked, answered plainly

Do I pay anything to use this service?

No. There's no fee to buyers at any stage. Introduction fees are paid by the Dubai broker or developer once a transaction completes — built into how the industry already operates.

Is this you selling me property directly?

No. This is an independent introduction service. Your requirement is passed to one regulated Dubai brokerage partner, who runs the actual sales process, viewings, contracts, and after-sales support.

Can I buy without visiting the UAE?

In most cases, yes — reservation, KYC, and signing can be completed remotely, with a visit optional rather than mandatory. Your matched broker will confirm what applies to a specific property.

What's the minimum investment for a Golden Visa?

As a general guide, UAE property-based Golden Visas have been available from AED 2 million (roughly £425,000–£450,000, depending on exchange rates) in qualifying property. Thresholds are set by UAE authorities and can change — your broker will confirm current criteria.

Is my money protected during construction (off-plan)?

Regulated developers are required to hold buyer payments in RERA-supervised escrow accounts, releasing funds against verified construction milestones rather than upfront. Always confirm a project's RERA registration and escrow status before paying anything.

What about UK or Indian tax on my Dubai property?

The UAE doesn't tax personal rental income or capital gains, but your UK tax residency (and, for NRIs, your Indian tax position) can still create obligations on income or gains at home. Worth a conversation with a qualified tax adviser before you buy.

Next steps

Your shortlist is two minutes away

If any of this resonates, the next step is simple: share your budget, goal, and timeline, and you'll be matched with a single vetted, RERA-regulated Dubai broker suited to your situation — no cold calls, no mass distribution, and no cost to you as a buyer.

Message on WhatsApp, or visit the enquiry page you received this guide from, to get started.

Important information

This guide is produced by an independent introducer based in the United Kingdom. We are not a licensed estate agent, financial adviser, mortgage broker or tax adviser, and we are not regulated by the FCA, RERA, or any equivalent body. We introduce prospective buyers to independently operating, third-party real estate brokerage partners based in Dubai, UAE, who are solely responsible for property listings, transaction advice, contracts, escrow arrangements and after-sales service. We receive a referral commission from broker partners when an introduction leads to a completed transaction; this guide and our service are free to buyers. Figures on rental yield, capital appreciation, tax treatment and visa eligibility referenced in this guide are general, indicative and subject to change — they are not a guarantee of performance and do not constitute financial, tax, immigration or legal advice. Property investment carries risk, including currency risk between GBP and AED and the risk of capital loss. You should seek independent financial, tax, legal and immigration advice before making any investment decision.